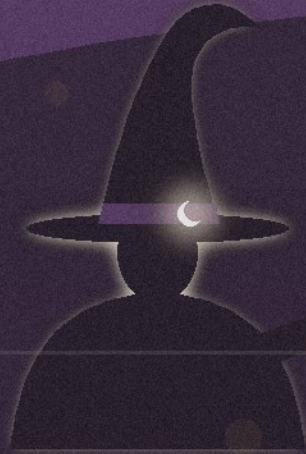


QUIETCLUECO PRESENTS

PLAYER KIT



MURDER AT THE LANTERN SUPPER

A MORROWMERE MURDER MYSTERY PARTY

6-12 PLAYERS · 2-3 HOURS · HOST CAN PLAY

WHAT TO PRINT

Player kit



Print only what your party needs. The host guide has the casting table: which roles to use for your number of guests.

- House rules and the plan of Larkwell Hall: one copy each, for the table.
- Character booklets: one per guest, only the roles you are using. Four pages each: Your character, Round 1, Round 2, Round 3. Fold or staple so only the current page shows.
- Evidence cards: one set, 11 cards, two to a page. Cut them in half and keep them in three envelopes by round.
- Detective's notes and an accusation sheet: one each per guest.
- Name badges: the roles you are using. Potion menu and awards: one each.



READ THESE ALOUD BEFORE ROUND 1

House rules

1. Everyone is a suspect. No booklet says who did it, not even the killer's own. Read your booklet as your character's memory: tell what it tells you, keep your secret until your booklet says to share it.
2. You may not show anyone your booklet. You may read lines aloud.
3. Your character only knows what is in your booklet. If someone asks you something you don't know, say so, or invent something harmless that does not change where anyone was.
4. The evidence cards are true. So is the plan of Larkwell Hall.
5. Nobody lies about where other people were. People can be wrong about themselves.

How a round works

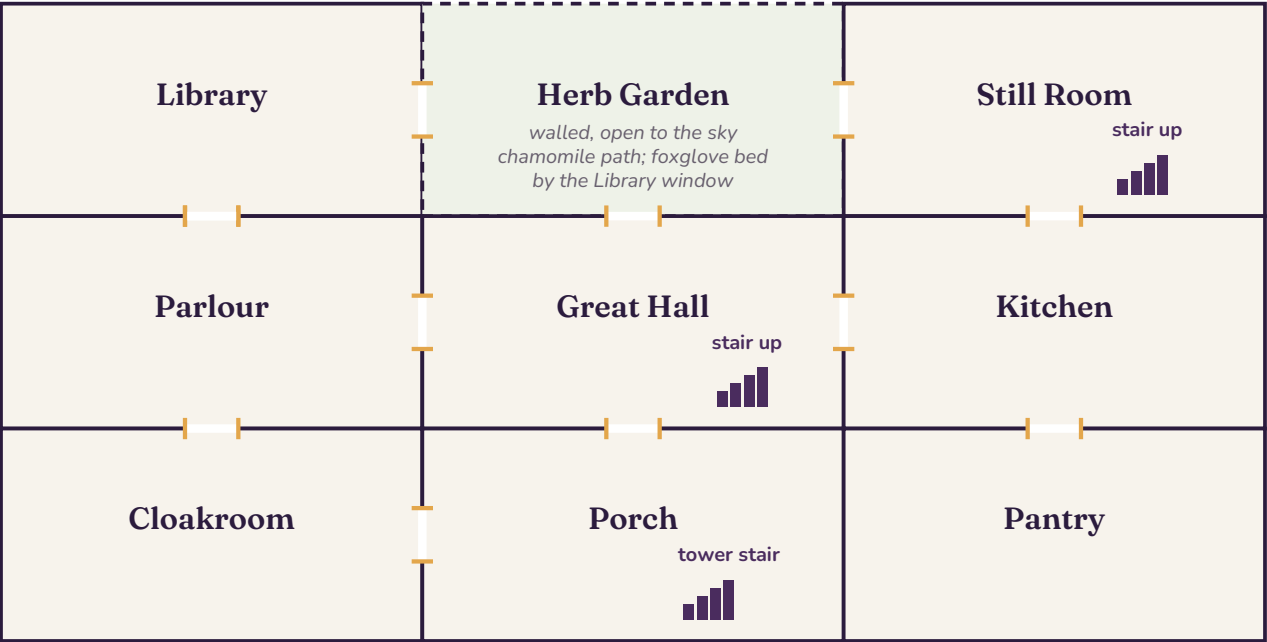
Each round: the host reads a short scene and puts new evidence cards on the table. Everyone reads the page of their booklet for that round, then mingle: ask questions, compare stories, study the cards and the plan. After Round 3, everyone writes an accusation.



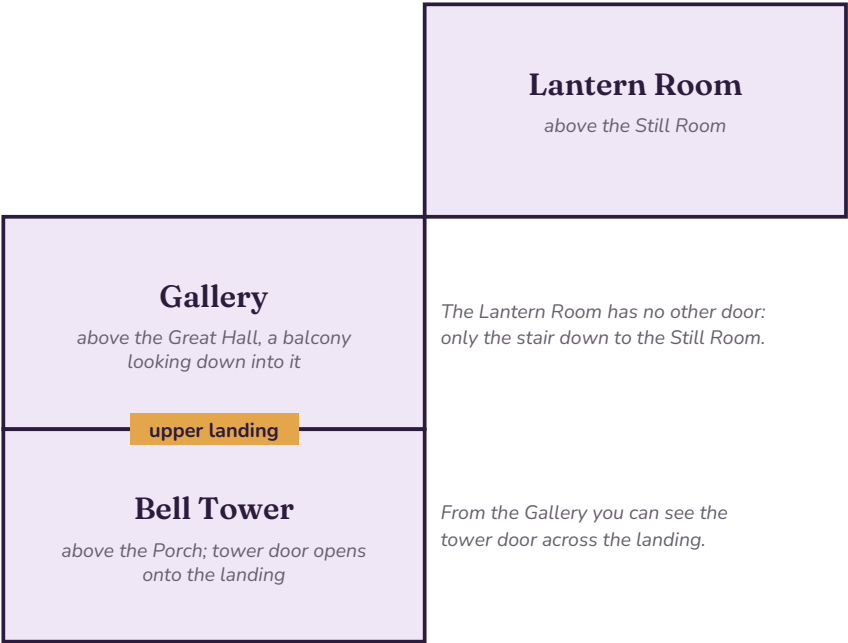
PUT THIS ON THE TABLE WITH THE EVIDENCE CARDS

The plan of Larkwell Hall

GROUND FLOOR (north at the top)



UPPER FLOOR (above the rooms below it)



— door · dashed: outdoors · The Kitchen has a serving hatch into the Great Hall and a window onto the herb garden. The Library's French window and the Great Hall's north door open onto the herb garden; the Still Room has its own garden door.



Cordelia Heatherly

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
CORE ROLE

Rowena's niece, who expects to inherit Larkwell Hall

Charming, impatient and sure the Hall will be hers one day.

You are Rowena's niece, her only family in Morrowmere (as far as anyone knows). You grew up running about Larkwell Hall, and everyone has always said that one day it will be yours. You have already chosen new curtains.

Lately Aunt Rowena has been strange with you: polite, distant, and twice she has stopped talking when you came into the room. Tonight she promised "an announcement at midnight".

Dress the part

Costume: velvet cape.

Your lantern candle: green.



Your secret

Just after ten you slipped up to the Gallery to look through the papers in Rowena's writing desk. You found half of a new will that leaves the Hall to the Hearth Circle, and you tore it in two before you could stop yourself. You are ashamed, and frightened of how it looks.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Who left the Great Hall after ten o'clock?
- Who knew about Aunt Rowena's cordial?
- Silas, why did my aunt want a word with you?



Cordelia Heatherly

ROUND 1 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: the niece, the heir, and very glad to see everyone. Say how fond you were of your aunt (it's true, mostly).

Where were you? Say you were in the Great Hall until about ten, “then upstairs for a little quiet”. Don’t say what you were doing.

What you saw: Rowena left the Great Hall for the Kitchen just before ten, humming.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Cordelia Heatherly

ROUND 2 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 2

The torn page has been found. Admit the truth: from ten past ten you were in the Gallery, reading Rowena's papers in the writing desk. You found the new will and tore it.

Your alibi: “From the Gallery I could see across the landing into the tower. Rufus was at the bell rope the whole peal, from a quarter past until it stopped at half past, and then he sat on the tower step until twenty to eleven. He never came down.”

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Cordelia Heatherly

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 3

Rowena meant to leave the Hall to the Circle. You are hurt, but you would never have harmed her. Say so.

Ask Isadora what she really came to Morrowmere for.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



Marigold Fenn

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
CORE ROLE

Keeper of the Still Room, the Circle's herbalist

Knows every plant in the garden and holds the only key to the poison cabinet.

You keep the Still Room at Larkwell Hall: the drying racks, the jars, the remedies and the locked poison cabinet, whose only key hangs on your belt. You have been Rowena's right hand for twenty years.

Everyone in the Circle knows Rowena means to name the next Lantern Keeper tonight, and everyone assumes it will be you. So do you.

Dress the part

Costume: herb apron.

Your lantern candle: amber.



Your secret

At a quarter past ten you slipped into the Pantry and took a jar of the Circle's heather honey to keep for yourself. It is a small thing, but in your position a very silly one.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Who has been in the herb garden tonight?
- Clementine, where were you during the peal?
- Who here knew Rowena kept her glass in the Still Room?



Marigold Fenn

ROUND 1 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: Keeper of the Still Room, Rowena's oldest friend in the Circle.

Where were you? In the Still Room until half past nine sorting the drying racks, then in the Kitchen helping Tamsin with the cider. At about a quarter past ten you stepped into the Pantry on your own “for more cups”, and were back in the Kitchen by half past.

What you saw: at ten Rowena poured her blackberry cordial in the Kitchen and tasted it. It was perfectly good then.

What you heard: soon after, Rowena's footsteps on the Lantern Room stair, above the Still Room.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Marigold Fenn

ROUND 2 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 2

The poison cabinet card: you are relieved. The bottle is full and sealed, so your key had nothing to do with it.

If someone asks about the Pantry, admit you took a jar of the Circle's heather honey. Blush.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Marigold Fenn

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 3

Rowena's speech notes say she meant to name Isadora, not you. You didn't know. Say so, and say it hurts.

You knew foxglove grows in the herb garden. So did every member of the Circle.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



Silas Ashgrove

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
CORE ROLE

Treasurer of the Hearth Circle

Counts every penny of the lantern fund. Lately, a little too carefully.

You are the treasurer of the Hearth Circle. You keep the lantern fund: the money that buys candles, pays for the Moon Fair and mends the Hall's roof.

You also love a game of cards, and you are very good at it.

Dress the part

Costume: waistcoat & pocket watch.

Your lantern candle: green.



Your secret

Since midsummer you have taken one hundred and twenty pounds from the lantern fund to pay the man who mended your own roof. You meant to put it back before anyone noticed. Rowena noticed.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Who went into the Still Room after ten?
- Cordelia, what were you doing upstairs?
- Rufus, did anyone come past the porch?



Silas Ashgrove

ROUND 1 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: treasurer, card player, keeper of every penny.

Where were you? “At ten o’clock I sat down to cards in the Library with Isadora Quince and Mother Meridew, and we played until twenty to eleven. Isadora never left the table, and neither did I. She won twice.”

Before that you were in the Parlour, talking to Clementine about the price of beeswax.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Silas Ashgrove

ROUND 2 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 2

The lantern fund book has been found. Admit the money is gone, and that you took it. You meant to repay every penny. Rowena wanted a word before the Supper, and you were dreading it.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Silas Ashgrove

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 3

You had a reason to fear Rowena, but you were at the card table the whole time. Remind everyone.

Ask Clementine why Rowena wanted her workshop back.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



Clementine Reed

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1

CORE ROLE

Candlemaker, whose workshop is in the Hall's coach house

Makes every candle the Circle burns, and tonight she brought the best of them.

You make every candle the Hearth Circle burns: the tall white ones for the Moon Fair, the lantern candles in everyone's colour, the little black ones children love. Your workshop is in the coach house behind Larkwell Hall, where your mother and her mother dipped candles before you.

Rowena has always been good to you. At least, she used to be.

Dress the part

Costume: wax-spattered smock.

Your lantern candle: green.



Your secret

This week Rowena told you she wants the coach house back. You begged her at supper tonight to change her mind, and she said she would "think about it until midnight".

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Marigold, who else has a key to the Still Room?
- Isadora, why did Rowena keep looking at you all night?
- Silas, what was in the lantern fund book?



Clementine Reed

ROUND 1 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: candlemaker, coach-house workshop, proud of tonight's lanterns.

Where were you? In the Great Hall at supper, then in the Parlour talking beeswax prices with Silas. After ten you went back to the Great Hall for the singing. At about a quarter past ten you went to the Cloakroom to look for your shawl, and you were back in the Great Hall by half past.

What you saw: Rowena carrying a green glass towards the Still Room just after ten.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Clementine Reed

ROUND 2 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 2

Say you heard the peal from the Cloakroom: it went on forever.

Ask Marigold who else has a key to the Still Room.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Clementine Reed

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 3

The notice to quit has been found. Admit Rowena meant to take back the coach house. You were heartbroken, not angry. You still hoped she would change her mind at midnight.

Point out that plenty of people here had a reason to want Rowena gone.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



Rufus Hawthorn

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
CORE ROLE

Caretaker and bellringer of Larkwell Hall

Has looked after the Hall for thirty years and rings its bell on every feast night.

You are the caretaker of Larkwell Hall and its bellringer. Thirty years of fixing the gutters, oiling the locks, chasing the jackdaws out of the chimneys and ringing the bell on every feast night.

Rowena is the best employer you ever had. Tonight you are in charge of the door and the bell.

Dress the part

Costume: tweed & keys.

Your lantern candle: white.



Your secret

For a year you have been leaving little poems on Mother Meridew's doorstep, unsigned. Tonight you put one in her coat pocket in the Cloakroom. If anyone mentions poems, you go very red.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Who went out into the herb garden tonight?
- Who came down the Gallery stair, and when?
- Isadora, have we met before?



Rufus Hawthorn

ROUND 1 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: caretaker and bellringer, keeper of every key except the poison cabinet's.

Where were you? On the Porch all evening greeting guests and keeping the lanterns lit, then “up to the tower” for the practice peal.

What you saw: Percival arriving at half past nine, last as usual, with his ledger under his arm.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Rufus Hawthorn

ROUND 2 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 2

The peal card is out. Tell everyone exactly what you saw: “I rang the practice peal from a quarter past ten until half past without a break. Cordelia was sitting in the Gallery, across the landing from the tower door, the whole time. I could see her through the open door, bent over the writing desk. She was still there when I came down at twenty to eleven.”

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Rufus Hawthorn

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 3

Somebody has found your poem. Admit it was yours, and that Mother Meridew is the finest woman in the valley.

Say the peal was the best you ever rang. Rowena would have been proud.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



Isadora Quince

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
CORE ROLE

A mapmaker who came to Morrowmere this autumn

A newcomer with sharp eyes, a sharper pencil and a reason for coming she hasn't told anyone.

You are a mapmaker. You arrived in Morrowmere this autumn to draw the valley, or so you told everyone. The truth: you were born at Larkwell Hall and sent away as a baby. Rowena Heatherly is your mother. You wrote to her in the summer, and she asked you to come home and keep it secret until the Lantern Supper.

Dress the part

Costume: travelling cloak.

Your lantern candle: violet.



Your secret

Rowena is your mother, and tonight she meant to tell the whole Circle. You have no idea what else she planned to announce.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Who was the last person to see Rowena alive?
- Marigold, what grows in the herb garden?
- Who here is not who they say they are? (Careful.)



Isadora Quince

ROUND 1 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: mapmaker, newcomer, delighted by the village.

Where were you? “From ten o’clock I played cards in the Library with Silas Ashgrove and Mother Meridew until twenty to eleven. Silas didn’t leave the table once; he was losing and wanted his money back.”

Before that you were in the Great Hall, watching Rowena laugh with the choir.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Isadora Quince

ROUND 2 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

CORE ROLE

Round 2

Ask Cordelia what she found in the Gallery desk.

If anyone asks why you really came to Morrowmere, say “for the maps” and change the subject.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Isadora Quince

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO
CORE ROLE

Round 3

Rowena’s speech has been found. Tell the truth: she was your mother, and she was going to name you Lantern Keeper. You only had her back for six weeks.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES

Handwriting lines for notes.



Mother Meridew

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
EXTRA ROLE

The village tea-leaf reader

Reads cups for anyone who asks, and remembers everything she reads.

You read tea leaves for anyone who brings you a cup, and you have read Rowena's every Halloween for forty years.

This morning her leaves showed a closed door and a candle. You did not like it.

Dress the part

Costume: shawls & spoons.

Your lantern candle: blue.



Your secret

Someone has been leaving unsigned poems on your doorstep for a year, and you rather hope it is Rufus.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Who brought Rowena her cordial?
- Who has a reason to fear a closed door?
- Rufus, do you write poetry?



Mother Meridew

ROUND 1 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: tea-leaf reader, Rowena's oldest friend outside the Circle.

Where were you? At cards in the Library from ten until twenty to eleven with Silas and Isadora. Neither of them left the table.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Mother Meridew

ROUND 2 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 2

Tell everyone about Rowena's leaves this morning: a closed door and a candle.

From the Library's French window you could see the herb garden, but the cards were good and you never looked up.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Mother Meridew

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO
EXTRA ROLE

Round 3

You found a poem in your coat pocket tonight. Read a line aloud and watch who goes red.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES

Lined area for notes.



Linnet Fairweather

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
EXTRA ROLE

Rowena's goddaughter, who sings in the choir

Rowena's favourite, and the one who found her.

You are Rowena's goddaughter. She taught you every song you know and sat with you through every fever you ever had.

Tonight you sang in the midnight choir in the Great Hall, and at a quarter to eleven you went to fetch her for the last rehearsal.

Dress the part

Costume: star-print dress.

Your lantern candle: gold.



Your secret

Rowena told you last week that she had "found someone she lost long ago", and made you promise not to tell. You think it might be Isadora.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Whose chair was by the north door?
- Who was Rowena going to name tonight?
- Who left the singing early?



Linnet Fairweather

ROUND 1 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: goddaughter, singer, the one who found Rowena.

Tell what you found: at a quarter to eleven, Rowena by the Still Room fire, very still, her green glass empty beside her. The garden door was open and the room was cold.

Where were you before? Singing in the Great Hall with the choir from ten o'clock.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Linnet Fairweather

ROUND 2 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 2

During the second verse, after a quarter past ten, you noticed a chair by the north door was empty, with a shawl over the back. You couldn't say whose.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Linnet Fairweather

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 3

Tell everyone what Rowena told you: she had found someone she lost long ago.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



Tamsin Rook

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
EXTRA ROLE

Cook of Larkwell Hall

Runs the kitchen, hears every door in the house and serves the best cider on the hill.

You are the cook of Larkwell Hall. You made tonight's supper, you kept the cider coming through the serving hatch, and you hear every door in the house.

You have never liked the Still Room: it smells of things that aren't food.

Dress the part

Costume: flour & ladle.

Your lantern candle: white.



Your secret

You have been feeding the Hall's cat Rowena's best cream for a year. The cat is enormous.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Marigold, what was in your apron?
- Who walked across the garden?
- Who was hungry enough to steal cream?



Tamsin Rook

ROUND 1 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: cook, cider-maker, ears of the house.

What you saw: at ten Rowena poured her blackberry cordial into the green glass, tasted it and said "Perfect." Then she took it to the Still Room.

What you heard: at a quarter past ten, Rowena's footsteps overhead on the Lantern Room stair.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Tamsin Rook

ROUND 2 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 2

At about a quarter past ten Marigold went into the Pantry on her own, and you heard the honey shelf creak. She came back with her apron bulging.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Tamsin Rook

ROUND 3 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 3

From the Kitchen window you saw a lantern bobbing across the herb garden at about a quarter past ten, but the window was steamed up and you couldn't see its colour.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



Percival Hobb

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
EXTRA ROLE

Clerk of the Hearth Circle

Writes down everything, especially what people would rather he didn't.

You are the clerk of the Hearth Circle. You write the minutes, keep the membership roll and know who owes what to whom.

You sing tenor in the midnight choir, rather loudly.

Dress the part

Costume: spectacles & ledger.

Your lantern candle: red.



Your secret

You have noticed the lantern fund doesn't add up, but you haven't said anything because Silas lent you his best fountain pen.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Silas, does the lantern fund add up?
- Cordelia, what did you take from the desk?
- Who here owes Rowena money?



Percival Hobb

ROUND 1 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: clerk, tenor, keeper of the minutes.

Where were you? You arrived at half past nine and sang in the Great Hall from ten until the choir broke up.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Percival Hobb

ROUND 2 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 2

You saw Cordelia go up the Gallery stair at about ten past ten, looking over her shoulder, and all through the second verse you could see her up there at the writing desk.

Say the lantern fund has been “a little thin” since midsummer.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Percival Hobb

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 3

Read from the minutes: at the last meeting Rowena said she would “settle the matter of the coach house before winter”.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



Ned Quarrie

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1

EXTRA ROLE

Fiddler of the midnight choir

Plays at every wedding, wake and feast in the valley, and never misses a beat.

You are the fiddler of the valley. Weddings, wakes, harvests: you have played them all.

Tonight you played for the midnight choir in the Great Hall.

Dress the part

Costume: fiddle & cap.

Your lantern candle: red.



Your secret

You once played at Clementine's cousin's wedding and forgot the second half of the first dance. She has never forgiven you.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Who left by the north door?
- Who carried a green lantern?
- Who sang flat? (Someone did.)



Ned Quarrie

ROUND 1 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: fiddler, never misses a beat.

Where were you? Playing for the choir in the Great Hall from ten until a quarter to eleven.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Ned Quarrie

ROUND 2 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 2

The peal: you had to play twice as loud to be heard over it, from a quarter past to half past ten. It never stopped.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Ned Quarrie

ROUND 3 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 3

You noticed green wax on the north door handle when you went out for air at a quarter to eleven. Mention it, if anyone asks about wax.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



Bryony Fettle

YOUR CHARACTER · READ BEFORE ROUND 1
EXTRA ROLE

The lantern girl

Lights every lantern in Morrowmere and notices every footprint on the way.

You are the lantern girl. Every lamp in Morrowmere is lit by you, and tonight you wrote every guest's candle colour in the lantern ledger at the door.

You are thirteen and you notice things.

Dress the part

Costume: lantern & scarf.

Your lantern candle: blue.



Your secret

You have been practising being a detective all year with Inspector Drummond's old notebook, which you found in the lost property box.

Keep this to yourself until your booklet tells you to share it.

Questions to ask tonight

- Who came in by the north door?
- What colour was your candle?
- Who had mud on their hem?



Bryony Fettle

ROUND 1 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 1

Introduce yourself: lantern girl, keeper of the lantern ledger.

Where were you? Lighting the garden lanterns at half past nine, then handing out song sheets in the Great Hall until half past ten.

This round

Say who you are and where you were. Listen to everyone else. Look at evidence cards 1–4 and the plan of the house.

MY NOTES



Bryony Fettle

ROUND 2 · READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 2

At half past ten you went out to relight the garden lanterns. There were fresh footprints across the chamomile, from the Great Hall's north door to the Still Room's garden door and back, past the foxglove bed next to the Library window.

This round

New evidence cards 5–8 are on the table. Some secrets come out now. Who can vouch for whom?

MY NOTES



Bryony Fettle

ROUND 3 • READ WHEN THE HOST SAYS SO

EXTRA ROLE

Round 3

Remind everyone of the lantern ledger: you wrote down every colour at the door.

This round

Evidence cards 9–11. After this round, everyone writes an accusation. Who could have been in the Still Room while Rowena was upstairs, and what proves it?

MY NOTES



ROUND 1 • CARD 1

The Green Glass

At ten o'clock Rowena poured her blackberry cordial into her green glass in the Kitchen and took a sip in front of Tamsin the cook. "Perfect," she said, and carried it to the Still Room.

At a quarter past ten she climbed the stair to the Lantern Room, above the Still Room, to trim the midnight lantern. Everyone in the Kitchen heard her footsteps overhead. She left the glass on the Still Room table.

At half past ten she came back down, sat by the fire and drank. At a quarter to eleven Linnet found her there, the glass empty beside her.

The doctor is certain: crushed foxglove went into the glass after Rowena climbed the stair and before she came back down.



cut here

ROUND 1 • CARD 2

The Lantern Ledger

Every guest at the Lantern Supper carries a lantern with a candle of their own colour. Bryony writes them all down at the door, as she does every year:

 Cordelia Heatherly	green	 Mother Meridew	blue
 Marigold Fenn	amber	 Linnet Fairweather	gold
 Silas Ashgrove	green	 Tamsin Rook	white
 Clementine Reed	green	 Percival Hobb	red
 Rufus Hawthorn	white	 Ned Quarrie	red
 Isadora Quince	violet	 Bryony Fettle	blue



ROUND 1 • CARD 3

The Choir and the Kitchen

From ten o'clock until a quarter to eleven the midnight choir rehearsed in the Great Hall in front of the fire: Linnet, Percival and Ned on the fiddle. Bryony handed round the song sheets until half past ten, then went out to relight the garden lanterns.

Tamsin never left the Kitchen all evening: she kept the cider coming through the serving hatch.

Mother Meridew played cards in the Library with two partners from ten until twenty to eleven and never left the table. Ask her partners who they were.

None of them could have reached the Still Room unseen.



cut here

ROUND 1 • CARD 4

The Still Room Floor

Wet garden mud and crushed chamomile on the Still Room floor, in a trail from the garden door to the table and back again. Someone came through the herb garden and in at the garden door.

On the table: Rowena's green glass, empty, and a few torn shreds of foxglove leaf.



ROUND 2 · CARD 5

The Practice Peal

At a quarter past ten the bell of Larkwell Hall began the practice peal for midnight. It rang without a single break until half past ten. Every guest heard it.

The bell rope hangs in the Bell Tower, and it takes two hands and a strong back to keep it going.



cut here

ROUND 2 · CARD 6

The Poison Cabinet

The poison cabinet in the Still Room is still locked. Marigold Fenn carries the only key on her belt.

Inside, the foxglove tincture bottle is full, its wax seal unbroken. Whoever poisoned Rowena did not need the key: the leaves in the glass were fresh, torn from the foxglove bed in the herb garden.



ROUND 2 · CARD 7

The Lantern Fund Book

The Hearth Circle's lantern fund book, found in Rowena's desk with a ribbon at the last page. One hundred and twenty pounds are missing since midsummer. Each withdrawal is initialled S.A.

In the margin, in Rowena's hand: "Speak to S. before the Supper."



cut here

ROUND 2 · CARD 8

A Torn Page

Half of a page torn from a new will, found in the Gallery desk:

"...and I leave Larkwell Hall, its garden and everything in it to the Hearth Circle, to be kept as a meeting house for as long as there is a lantern to light..."

The other half is missing.



ROUND 3 · CARD 9

The Rim of the Glass

Under Inspector Drummond's lens: a single drip of candle wax on the rim of the green glass, hard and smooth. It fell from the poisoner's own lantern as they bent over the glass.

The wax is green.



cut here

ROUND 3 · CARD 10

Rowena's Speech

Rowena's notes for her midnight speech, folded in her pocket:

"Tonight I name the next Lantern Keeper of the Hearth Circle. Not the one you expect: my daughter, Isadora Quince, who came home to me this autumn after thirty years."



ROUND 3 · CARD 11

A Notice to Quit

A notice in Rowena's writing desk, ready but unsigned:

"To Clementine Reed. The lease of the coach house workshop at Larkwell Hall ends at Martinmas. The candle trade must find another home."

Pinned to it: "Sign at midnight."



cut here



Detective's notes

Extra guests (the choir, the cook, Mother Meridew and the lantern girl) are on evidence card 3.

Notes

My accusation



My name: _____

Who poisoned Rowena? _____

How did they get to the glass, and when? _____

Which evidence proves it? _____

Why did they do it? _____

My accusation



My name: _____

Who poisoned Rowena? _____

How did they get to the glass, and when? _____

Which evidence proves it? _____

Why did they do it? _____



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Cordelia Heatherly

Rowena's niece, who expects to inherit Larkwell Hall



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Marigold Fenn

Keeper of the Still Room, the Circle's herbalist



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Silas Ashgrove

Treasurer of the Hearth Circle



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Clementine Reed

Candlemaker, whose workshop is in the Hall's coach house



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Rufus Hawthorn

Caretaker and bellringer of Larkwell Hall



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Isadora Quince

A mapmaker who came to Morrowmere this autumn



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Mother Meridew

The village tea-leaf reader



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Linnet Fairweather

Rowena's goddaughter, who sings in the choir



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Tamsin Rook

Cook of Larkwell Hall



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Percival Hobb

Clerk of the Hearth Circle



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Ned Quarrie

Fiddler of the midnight choir



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Bryony Fettle

The lantern girl



THE LANTERN SUPPER · LARKWELL HALL

Inspector Hollis Drummond

Your host for the evening



The Potion Menu

LARKWELL HALL • THE LANTERN SUPPER

Bramble Cauldron Punch

Blackberry, apple and a cinnamon stick, served warm from a pot.

Spellbound: add a splash of dark rum to each cup. · Moonless: as it is, with a twist of orange.

Hob Hill Cider Fizz

Cloudy apple cider over ice with ginger and a slice of pear.

Spellbound: use hard cider. · Moonless: sparkling apple juice.

Moon-Milk Nightcap

Warm milk with honey, vanilla and a pinch of nutmeg.

Spellbound: a spoon of spiced rum or brandy. · Moonless: perfect as it is (oat milk works too).

Ember Ginger Spritz

Ginger beer, lime and a few dark cherries, very cold.

Spellbound: a measure of gin. · Moonless: as it is, with extra lime.

Decorate with lemon balm, mint or rosemary. Never use foxglove or any garden plant you are not sure of: in this story it is a poison, and in real life it is one too.



THE HEARTH CIRCLE AWARDS

Best Detective

awarded to

date

signed by the Inspector



THE HEARTH CIRCLE AWARDS

Best Costume

awarded to

date

signed by the Inspector



THE HEARTH CIRCLE AWARDS

Best Performance

awarded to

date

signed by the Inspector



THE HEARTH CIRCLE AWARDS

Most Suspicious

awarded to

date

signed by the Inspector

